

University of California, Berkeley 3

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Expertise, and so domain expertise, but I also mean things like judgment, or discernment, or taste. So I'm kind of excited to unpack what some of those concepts might mean as we run through the questions. I'll also say we've certainly just seen goals be multiplied aggressively because of Gen I. I think there's an assumption, certainly in our company, and a lot of not publicly traded but still pro-staged companies, where it's like, we have these productivity gains because of these tools, so now the goals are here.

And new teams figure it out. That might be shorter velocity on sales cycle. It might be faster delivery on product and engineering and things like that.

So a lot of opportunity, but also a lot of challenge. And I feel like the, what's the expression? I suppose the goalposts are being pulled even further back. Thank you.

Jerry, I actually have a follow-up question for you. In your role as the VP of Education Partnerships, I'm sure you are in direct conversation with a lot of university leaders. I'm curious from the conversation that you've been having, how is Gen I thinking about the way that universities are thinking about student career outcomes? What are they most optimistic, excited, or anxious about as these changes unfold? Yeah, so I have a pretty non-traditional tech job.

I actually, my team settles into and then helps university career centers, about 1,600 across the United States, essentially run the career center, including a lot of it here at, controversially, not here at Haas, but definitely for Berkeley undergrads. And to be honest, we see the whole spectrum. We have some really innovative customers and partners that are very optimistic.

They see it as a revolutionary way to think about personalization and customization, certainly for things like career coaching and, I think, using data to make much, much better decisions for their student body. To be a little bit spicy, there are also a lot of universities and leaders who seem like they want to put their head in the sand instead. And it's kind of like, challenge the status quo, right? As a Haas alum, it was drilled into my mind, right? I think there are a lot of leaders that would prefer to kind of maintain the status quo and kind of hold on to things.

I do want to make this interactive. Arnon and I talked about that. How many people know what the enrollment cliff is? Just to talk about higher ed for a second.

Anyone? Enrollment cliff. Enrollment cliff, thanks. I'm not closing the thing.

No, just kidding. Just kidding. Oh, I love it.

Nobody, really? Okay, so the enrollment cliff is, Arnon? I know a cliff. This is a very interesting phenomenon. It's about to hit, actually, for the class of 25 and 26.

And essentially, that birth rate's really dropped during the Great Recession in 2008. So the sort of, the incoming classes of college students will basically go down in the next, I think, don't quote me on this, I think it's like 25% over like the next 10 to 15 years. So universities actually have this massive challenge where it's kind of like the advent and the uncertainty of AI with this looming enrollment cliff.

And so, for the optimists, I think they see opportunity. They wanna be more innovative. They wanna use these tools to serve students better.

They want to be kind of on the cusp of figuring out what are the new jobs in this AI economy. And then for the folks that are less innovative, I think it's a huge challenge, right? You basically have this multiplied challenge of the sort of supply, the top of funnel, I should say, coming in of students. It's like you literally compete, even Berkeley will compete for, well, I don't know if Berkeley will, right? Because it's such high demand.

But these schools are really gonna compete for students to come in. And you could make the case that CHAT-GPT is getting close, or I should single out CHAT-GPT. CLOD, you know, Perplexity, all these tools are getting pretty close to, maybe, if you kind of squint at it, a college education as well, right? Universities are really having to kind of invent and reinvent themselves.

Awesome, that's very useful context. And next, I wanted to switch gears a little bit and actually talk about Gen-AI adoption inside organizations. To kick us off, could you both share how you're seeing AI improving productivity or decision-making within your respective organizations, and what has been harder than expected? I can start.

So, in the conversation before, I had mentioned that there's several non-technical teams that are within the environment. And I think a lot of the, now the engineers and the product team, they're using a lot of different tools on a daily basis. But what I found is that there's a, we're pushing our own non-technical population to use tools in every aspect of their role.

We challenge them to say, look, there's process improvements you can make. Why don't you just try different tools to see if it helps your job, right? One example is, we did this employee survey, and we have over 9,000 people in the company. We did an employee survey.

We had thousands and thousands of written comments, thousands of written comments. My head of L&D, learning development, came in and said, okay, well, I have all these comments from the survey, I'm gonna start analyzing them. And I said, well, why don't, let's use all the tools available, put it into Gemini, put it in Chatsy, whatever you wanna do, let's try some different things at a very easy level.

Like, this is easy stuff. Like, you're trying to get adoption, right? You're trying to get people to feel comfortable. So, we put all of the comments into a, and we have a nice internal enterprise-wide confidential tool so that the data doesn't get out into the world.

So, it's nice. So, it's all contained. And out came the themes for the company.

Out, we analyzed everything in seconds. So, what we did was, we were able then to have the themes, we were able to break it down by organization, and give all of the leaders, this is your information. Not only do you have your quantitative, you have your qualitative information, very easy, within the same day, right? It seems logical, but sometimes people within companies need to be nudged a little bit to help.

It's okay to let go and not do it the way you did it yesterday, and try something new. So, then we could spend more time on doing engagement conversations with employees, we can look at the data, we can action plan, we can actually improve the environment, instead of spending two weeks to analyze the data, we did it within a day and got it out. Very simple, all of you can really relate to that.

It's super important. But, in kind of the more difficult part, I don't know if it's difficult, it really is about adoption, and about meeting people where they're at, and about introducing things that are non-scary, right? It's about being non-scary. Because people inherently, sometimes they're afraid that this will take over their job.

Like, I do this, I said, no, no, no, it's gonna redefine what you do. It's gonna make you better. So, don't think about it, and don't avoid using these tools because you're scared, or you're apprehensive, you need to embrace it.

So, the hardest thing is just getting people over that mental, psychological hurdle, that this is here to be leveraged, I can redefine my role to something more productive, and then build much more capability for the organization. Yeah, I definitely can riff on that. To redefinition, definitely, McCarthy, and we see at Handshake as well.

I'll just give some maybe practical examples to bring some of those things to life. So, I'd say at Handshake, we're kind of in between, I would say most of our sort of 650 employees will use some form of generative AI on a day-to-day basis. We're kind of transitioning, or kind of along the spectrum, moving towards like agentic AI.

And so, what I mean by that is like, gen AI, to use a very similar example as Arnaud's, right? I need to submit an RFP for a school that is interested in using Handshake. You know, used to take somebody literally, I mean, you might copy over an old one, but like actually writing out a 40-page RFP, now we can basically ask gen AI to do the outline of that, or some of that for us. Now, I'd say that's about 40 to 50% good.

What I mean by agentic is we are starting to see ways where it's like, not only will the AI tool help us write kind of the response, but it will go out and find, proactively find all of the RFP opportunities, maybe even create some of the logins for those state or public portals, maybe even do some of the communication and then write. I think, again, we're about 40 to 50% of that. Another interesting example, the fair amount of kind of marketing and comms that we all

do in our go-to-market roles at Handshake.

So, we have sort of, again, sort of proto-agents that have the voice of our CEO. Like, how would Garrett answer this question, or how would my boss, our Chief Education Strategy Officer, Christine, answer this question? And it's like 70 or 80% there as well. I think it's quite good.

Finally, I think one really interesting example, our talent and recruiting teams, I shouldn't say surprisingly, but I think they've been among the most innovative and kind of tooled up. And so, really, really, really redefining how to look for candidates kind of at scale, how to do outreach, how to do sort of top of funnel of that overall interview, or not interview, but the recruiting process. Although, a lot of that interviews as well.

Yeah. I was gonna mention that, yeah, usually the recruiting team seems to be early adopters to lots of stuff where it uses the resumes, it uses all the tools to curate, right? Yes, and there is a whole bunch of tools out there on the interview site. Yeah.

You can actually simulate people, simulate conversations. That's right. Different personalities, and this is all really accessible to lots of companies.

That's correct, yeah. Awesome, that's very useful context. Arnon, I actually have a couple follow-up questions for you.

So, previously, you've actually mentioned that there is a three-part AI framework at Snowflake. Just wondering if you could walk us through what that looks like in practice, as well as in your, as you're thinking about your own goal, how do you balance investing in AI with investing in people? Do you see attention there? And if so, how do you deal with it? Sure. So, sometimes to make things digestible for people, they need a framework, right? They need a framework.

So, the wireframe we put together at the company that I think is catching on really well is three-pronged, as we mentioned. The first one is basically how do you utilize the world of AI in a corporate setting? So, other companies are different. I'll speak to what we did and what we're doing at Snowflake.

So, kind of three pillars. The first one is anything repetitive, you should fully utilize AI. Anything repetitive, right? So, that means if you're doing something and it's rote, and you can actually find a way to automate that.

So, you automate anything repetitive. And I'll explain that in a second. If it's creative, we augment.

That means that you do some of the work and AI does some of the work, but ultimately you're creating that product at the end. And then the third, and I mentioned before, is that if it's judgment related, if it has to do with social intelligence, you don't use AI at all, right? I say it has to stay human. And I tell people that, and I'll give you an example of that last one.

Let's say you want to give people a personal promotion, or you want to talk about their performance, or you want to engage with them in a certain way, you don't use AI to cultivate. It just comes from you as a human to connect with another human. Because that's the way that we're going to stay human, all the way through this process.

If I look at augmenting, going backwards, a great example is that we created internally a peer-to-peer mentor, mentee program, so that people could sign up, maybe early career folks could sign up in the company, lots of, as a mentee, a lot of mentors would come in, they put the profiles in the system, and then the system matches them, right? So that they get their best mentor over the course of six months to have those discussions. And then repetitive tasks, I really looked, I mean, I'm seriously nudging the team. Find anything you can that is high volume repetitive, and let's automate it, right? Two examples.

The first example is around writing job descriptions. Writing job description sometimes would take anywhere from a half hour, an hour and a half to finish, like you're writing, you're thinking about it, you're putting all the elements in it, you're looking at previous ones, and then the manager looks at it, and it's hours and hours and hours of writing job descriptions especially if you're growing fast. So we created a tool that you just put in the job title, a couple of small things, literally less than five minutes, and it develops, it looks at all of our internal, all the historic job descriptions, it goes out to the internet, and it creates this beautifully written job description with all the elements that we expect in it, and it does it in just a few minutes.

We've already realized, we've already launched this, it's already saved two years of people time. Two years, right? If you think about it, two years within just that tool, two years of savings that people could do other things. Right? It's incredible.

The other thing is so simple, and I tell companies all the time you should do this. You know, Zoom has it, different applicant tracking systems has it, but it takes notes for you as you have interviews. In the old way, you're sitting there and talking to somebody, you're writing stuff down, you're trying to remember stuff, and then you go, oh my gosh, I have to write all this, and I have to remember the conversation, I spent an hour with this person, and what did they say? But they have these beautiful just summaries that just magically come into your inbox.

You can take it, you can modify it a little bit, put it into the system. It's so simple, and it saves years, years off of people time. So this is really important, just to think about repetitive tasks, how you can automate it.

So those are three pillars. I'll just, and then I'll stop there. It's, if you're repetitive, you automate.

Anything that is creative, you augment, right? And judgment and emotional intelligence is human led. Right, that's the structure, and I put it out there into the world, and people now follow that pattern. It really works for folks.

The second question was around, the second part, I'll just briefly. How do you balance investing

in AI tools with investing in people? Do you see that as a tension, or if so, how do you deal with it? Well, I think I'll start with, we, remember I mentioned that I had to make this non-scary. So let me just talk about a little bit of the training that I'll pass it on.

Yeah, yeah. So what we did is, we did a few things. One is that we created a class called prompt engineering.

Prompt engineering, right? All, for non-technical. All it is, is it teaches you how to talk to whatever natural language tool you have. And it's a 15 minute class.

You take it, and you practice, right? So all the people who have been a little bit bashful about getting online and doing these type of tools actually have now a real practice, and we get groups. Everybody watches the video, and then we do it together, right? So, oh my gosh, you used the tools. We created an amazing course.

It's not public, but I'm gonna say it anyway, because it's all family here today, is that we created an amazing course internally called AI for Everyone. It's a set of courses, 10 courses, that takes you through all the Snowflake products, but also all, just in general, tells you about the concept, talks about the history of AI, so that you have this elegant coursework that you can just take as you want. There's live classes that you can take.

There's recorded classes, and we do it for everybody, right? And so everybody needs to take it. I have all of my people on the people team are all taking these courses, and we're going to have discussion sessions at the end, right? So basically, the last part is, then once we do all that, then we start with very simple, easy things, where I ask everybody to find one thing in their workday that they can automate. One thing.

Let's just do it. Everybody do it, and then they report out to me at the end of the week, report to your manager. So everyone's finding these little things to automate, so, you know, it's not that bad.

So once they learn academically, once they have the framework, and then once they actually play with the tools, it becomes much easier for adoption. No, I mean, I'll be so bold as to speak to Arnaud as far as just the blunt question of people over AI. Arnaud was sharing with me in his first year at Snowflake, you hired, what, 3,000 people? 10,000, so I think that's a big part of the answer.

We'll talk about anxiety and trends, but I think that's a lot. Yeah, totally. And my next question is, what do you see as a key difference between companies that will truly lose AI versus those that simply just view it as a productivity tool? Yeah, we can start with that one, maybe some push-pots.

So, I'll say, I'm actually, so I'll self-disclose a little bit. I'm a 43-year-old dad, grew up with the internet to some degree, right, but I'm not one of these, like, oh, AI first, or AI native on everything. Between that part of the spectrum and being a total Luddite, I'm probably

somewhere in the middle.

I do, from the work we do at Handshake, though, see that, like, I think AI will genuinely, like, kind of touch every industry, sector. It will definitely kind of reinvent, redefine roles based on, I think, productivity is the lens that people are looking at right now. But I say that to say, I think the two factors that boil down to me, I would say, one is kind of like Arnon is talking about, where AI and Gen-AI is part of the core strategy.

It's not just, like, this tool on the side, that, like, oh, you know, everybody's gotta use this to get 5% better. It is, like, part of, I'll give you guys, like, an example, and I promise this will be the one time I kind of stump for Handshake today on stage, but I think we're the first career sort of social network that has, like, natural language job search right now. So, like, if you are a job seeker, which I know, especially many of the second-year students are and will be here at Haas, you know, if you go on LinkedIn, you go on Indeed, you go on ZipRecruiter, you're still using, like, manual filters, right? Oh, I want a job in San Francisco.

Maybe I'm typing in marketing. So, Handshake, we're in the process of rolling out a full AI search or natural language search, which is just to say, and I think consumers and all of you probably expect this, right? I wanna say, I'm looking for a product marketing manager role at a C to series B company in the health tech space in and around Boston Metro, and, like, your tool should recommend those jobs instead of, you know, clicking, like, a bunch of things and messing with it. So, there's this piece about, like, is it actually in your product if you're a software company, right? And is it actually part of, kind of, your core strategy? And then the second thing, I'm gonna mess up his name, but the gentleman ahead of us at GitHub Next, sorry, if you're still here, I'm not gonna attempt it.

The gentleman from GitHub, who I was very impressed with. Idan? Yeah. Building on that, I think, like, this culture of, like, experimentation is really, really important, like, that may actually be the key differentiator.

So, as Arunan said, kind of, some more talented recruiting leaders really being on the cutting edge of some of the tools that we're using and adopting, like, it comes down to the, kind of, willingness to be curious and experiment, you know? And one thing, I totally agree with Elias, and one thing I'd add to that is, kind of, thinking about it, is that companies, I think, are, to be productive in the space a little bit, and to differentiate themselves, and to, kind of, win, it doesn't matter when, is that when you automate something that's repetitive, let's say, then you teach people how to use that time to do something more productive. You teach people how to be doing something more meaningful, right, something that's more, that can propel their career. And it creates this culture, I think, of always finding ways to redefine yourself as a professional, so that you can automate, but you're not losing something.

Basically, you're gaining time to then reinvent yourself within the company, and you create an environment where that is acceptable, that is actually asked for, you want that to happen. So, then you create this environment where people are, hey, I can automate this, and then I can

learn this skillset. I can automate this, and then I can expand my capability, or I can get to this project that I never have time for, because at the end of the day, I'm moving to it.

So, it's just like, if you start, and it's this perpetual virtuous cycle, where you actually can create a much better company. That's awesome. Actually, what you both shared, you reminded me of a couple questions I wanted to ask, that are actually not PR approved, but I might as well go ahead and see it.

The first question is, I was curious, so you guys both mentioned that AI will impact every single job, or all parts of the workforce. I'm curious, especially for you, Arnon, how do you think about workforce planning in your role, and what kind of role do you think will have the most disruption, especially with Gen AI? Well, let's see. So, let me do the workforce planning piece first.

So, the way the workforce planning works in companies, for those who will jump into companies, is that usually once a year, they think about what projects they're gonna deliver as a company, and then they think how to resource that financially, how many people you need to support that, and then what skill sets, right? Skill sets, and you put it all together, and you have your workforce plan, in a nutshell. And so, the one advantage, and I'll speak to this more myopically, is that because our organization is all based on Gen AI, that there's a lot of it built into our plan already. So, where I think it's gonna have the biggest impact is kind of what I mentioned before, is the non-technical population, right? Because the technical population's already using Cursor, it's already using other applications to just go faster and amplify their expertise.

It's really about the non-technical population that is learning how to use these tools to redefine their jobs, and to do more meaningful work. And so, I find it actually as, and I've pitched this across the company, it's super exciting, because you can actually, each person can figure out how they want to be in six months, right, what kind of role it is. So, the second thing I wanna say to this is that, in general, I think what's gonna happen with job descriptions, I'll do a little prediction, is that it's going to more emphasize the human aspect in jobs.

So that when people look at job descriptions, it'll say, okay, can you utilize these tools, right? Do you have this basic expertise to be able to leverage these tools, and do great prompts, and make sure that your expertise gets the right answer? But are you able to connect as a human? So, the human emotional intelligence aspect, I think it's going to be, creep its way into job descriptions, and roles will be redefined as, do you have an ability to connect with another person? That was very helpful. Next part of the question will be around upscaling and talent development, as well as, just in culture. So, my first question is, actually, Arnon, I think you kind of touched on it, but maybe, Jerry, you might have something else you wanna add.

Looking ahead to talent development, what are two to three durable skills that will help you matter, even as AI embedded in every single function? And maybe, as an add-on to what you just said, how do you actually assess emotional intelligence through, in the hiring process? I can

definitely start with two to three, for sure. So, look, I think, by show of hands, mostly an MBA audience, yes? So, we haven't talked about leadership. I think that's absolutely a durable skill, just to say the obvious.

An AI could say the words, I suppose, that Arnon and I are saying here, in front of our teams and companies, but I think an AI's still pretty far from motivating, inspiring, influencing, persuading. So, I think those skills, to Arnon's point, will become more and more important. I don't know if my CEO will kill me for saying this, because we are also building some interview tools.

But I think one of the answers to how you assess is, yeah, I still have people talk to people, right? Like, you interview, you interview, but if you don't just have an AI kind of do the entire recruiting experience and funnel, I think it's really important to do that. I'll say one other sort of durable skill. We talked a lot about judgment.

I think one example I'm confronted with weekly at work is I work for Better for Worse a lot with our legal team. And so, our legal team is always telling me, in very kind of complex gray situations, well, Jerry, here's the legal risk, right? And I would say a sophisticated, or really powerful LLM can maybe do that. But you still need to make the business decision, right, based on that risk.

And that involves discernment, and experience, and pattern recognition. And you know, I think AIs are, again, on the maybe proto side of doing some of those things. But like, those pieces will always be important for a human told.

Now I'm just gonna add to you, I think it's an excellent list. And what I add is, I think some of those durable behavioral components is one is, I think we talked about performance mindset, right? It's openness to accepting these, accepting all the new technologies moving fast. So are you, do you have a mindset where you're resistant, or do you embrace it? Can you leverage it? Right? And the second one I think is super important, and it's more important as I've been in this role for over a year now, to really look at the type of people that we're hiring in the company.

But is there, and I think the last, Yidan I think mentioned this in the last session, but it's this natural, natural curiosity, right? It's not just proving that you can use the tools, but it's like, did you on a weekend say, wow, I just saw this new tool, I'm gonna download it, and I'm gonna play with it, and I'm gonna just figure it out, and I'm gonna test it? Do you have a natural inclination to pull that thread, to explore something that you're uncomfortable with, and learn from it? Because that is a core skill set, as things move fast in this world, that you're gonna have this natural sense of curiosity that you want to pull that thread, and naturally come out of your interviews, right? It's not just, oh, I've used, I got the tool, I checked the box, I used it once, now I'm proficient. No, and then you explain, you know, I built this website, there's a story that we have that this father and son team, it was told to me just a couple weeks ago, Cursor is a programming tool, where it has a natural language component, but you just tell it to do, and it

actually develops all the code, like it's insane. And this father and son team wanted to create a new business and they wanted to create a website.

So they sat with this tool, so they downloaded it, got a copy of it, with a natural language, they kept telling it what to do, they kept modifying it, kept iterating it. Within a week, after just playing with it, they had the most amazing website that took payments, that was interactive, they built this entire business, just the two of them, and they were not technical, right? But they had the curiosity and the fortitude to play with the tool, to figure it out, to iterate, that's not quite right, let's try a different prompt, but they have no technical background. So that natural inclination to be curious, to pull threads, to experiment, to try new things, that's gonna be super important, and I'm gonna say it again, that should come out in your interview.

Thank you for that. Jerry, I wanna turn to you to talk a bit more about Handshake AI.

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